

The NetSec Design System

The visual and interaction language of the NetSec public site and its EISS × NetSec conference materials. Apple-inspired glassmorphism over EU / COST brand colours: modern, trustworthy, and Brussels-adjacent without being corporate.

On this document. The system was reverse-engineered from the project's own code and brand kit. Colours, type, brand marks and the slide language are drawn from the live site. The spacing scale, the radii set beyond the two the site ships, and the motion / blur / shadow tokens are a tidied, *partly aspirational* layer: a clean architecture the code does not yet fully implement. Treat those as the intended direction, not a description of `site.css` today.

Design language

Restraint over decoration. White space, generous line-height and one strong colour beat busy gradients and animated icons. Almost every distinct piece of information sits in a frosted glass card, and those cards define the hierarchy.

1 • Restraint over decoration

White space and one accent do the work.
No busy gradients, no animated icons.

2 • Glass cards as the unit of UI

The frosted card is the building block. It carries elevation and groups meaning.

3 • Stroke icons, brand marks apart

Lucide-style stroke glyphs for generic concepts, true brand marks only for brands.

4 • Motion is a hint

Hover transforms stay within 4 px, transitions within 300 ms. No parallax or scroll-jacking.

5 • British English

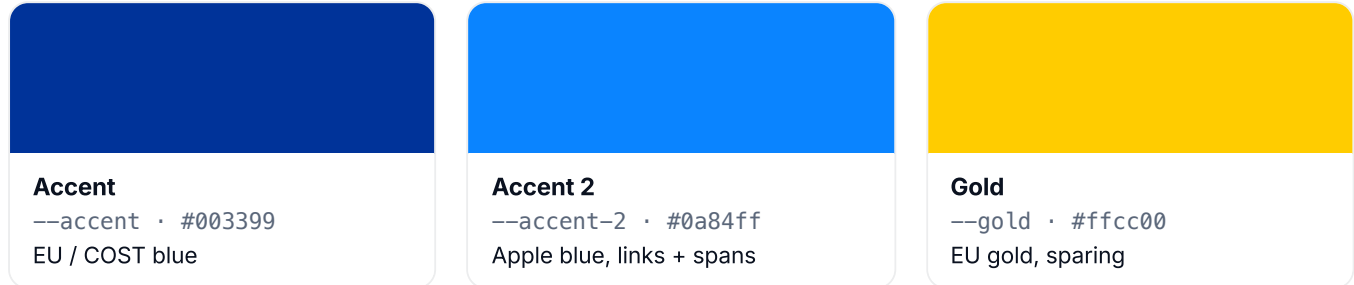
One voice across every surface, hand-translated to French and German.

6 • Accessibility first

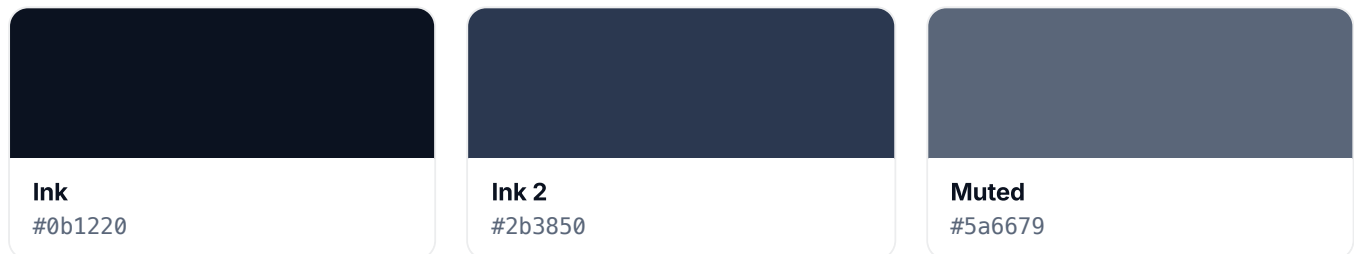
Keyboard-reachable, WCAG 2.1 AA in both the light and the dark theme.

Colour

Brand accents



Ink & neutrals (light)

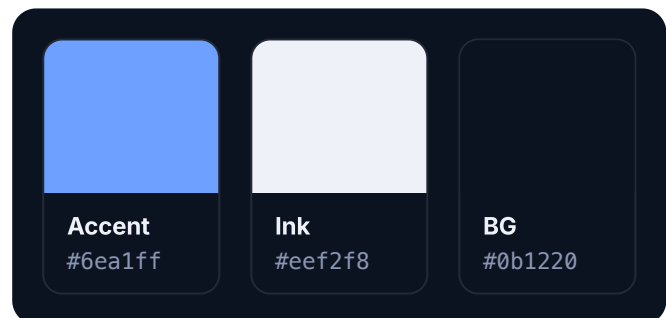


Working Group palette



#0a84ff · #10b981 · #8b5cf6 · #f59e0b — colour-codes chips and cards by Working Group.

Dark theme



Glass surfaces

--glass-bg rgba(255,255,255,.55) · --glass-border
rgba(255,255,255,.6) · blur saturate(160%) blur(18px). The
frosted card, floated over the page ambience gradient.

Typography

Lexend — display and headings, weights 400–700, letter-spacing $-.02\text{em}$. High x-height, friendly, tuned for reading speed.

Inter — body and UI, weights 400–800, line-height 1.55. Battle-tested at small sizes. Both self-hosted, no Google Fonts request.

`--fs-h1 · clamp(2.4rem, 5.2vw, 4.4rem) · Lexend 700`

The threat landscape

`--fs-h2 · clamp(1.8rem, 3.2vw, 2.6rem) · Lexend 600`

Networking European Security

`--fs-h3 · 1.25rem · Lexend 600`

Working Group programme

`--fs-lede · clamp(1.05rem, 1.4vw, 1.2rem) · Inter 400`

A lede paragraph in Inter, one step above body, introducing a section.

`--fs-body · 1rem · Inter 400`

Body copy in Inter at the base size, line-height 1.55 for comfortable reading.

`--fs-eyebrow · .78rem · Mono, uppercase, letter-spacing .14em`

SECTION EYEBROW LABEL

Weights

300 400 500 600 700

Spacing, radii & effects

Aspirational layer. The live `site.css` ships only `--radius`, `--radius-sm`, `--maxw` and the glass / accent tokens. The full 8 px spacing scale, the six-radius set and the motion / blur / shadow tokens below are the intended token architecture, currently hardcoded inline in the CSS.

Spacing scale

TOKEN	VALUE	
<code>--space-1</code>	4px	
<code>--space-2</code>	8px	
<code>--space-4</code>	14px	
<code>--space-6</code>	24px	
<code>--space-8</code>	32px	
<code>--space-12</code>	48px	
<code>--space-20</code>	80px	

Radii

TOKEN	VALUE	
<code>--radius</code>	22px	
<code>--radius-sm</code>	14px	
<code>--radius-btn</code>	13px	
<code>--radius-pill</code>	999px	

Layout

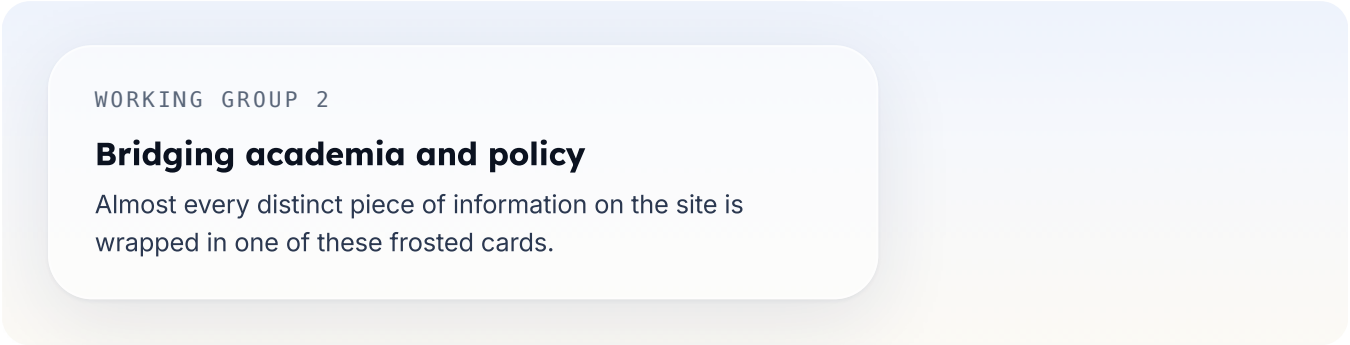
<code>--maxw</code>	1180px
<code>--gutter</code>	24px
<code>--nav-offset</code>	90px

Motion, blur & elevation

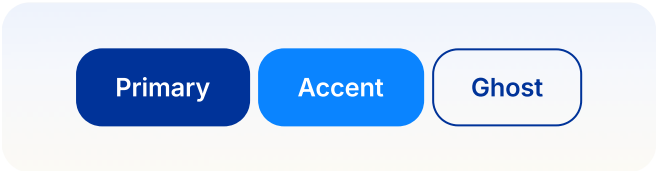
TOKEN	VALUE	ROLE
<code>--ease</code>	<code>cubic-bezier(.22,.61,.36,1)</code>	Apple-ish overshoot, default curve
<code>--dur</code> / <code>--dur-slow</code>	<code>.25s</code> / <code>.35s</code>	Default and slow transitions
<code>--blur-glass</code>	<code>saturate(160%) blur(18px)</code>	Glass card backdrop
<code>--lift</code>	<code>translateY(-4px)</code>	Card hover lift
<code>--shadow-md</code>	<code>0 10px 40px rgba(20,35,80,.10)</code>	Glass elevation

Core components

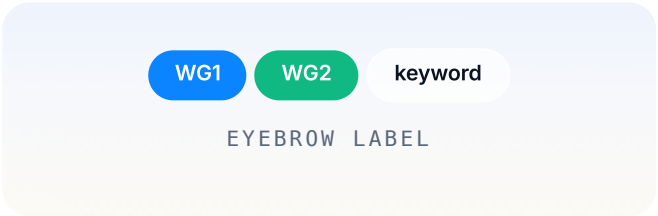
Glass card — the workhorse



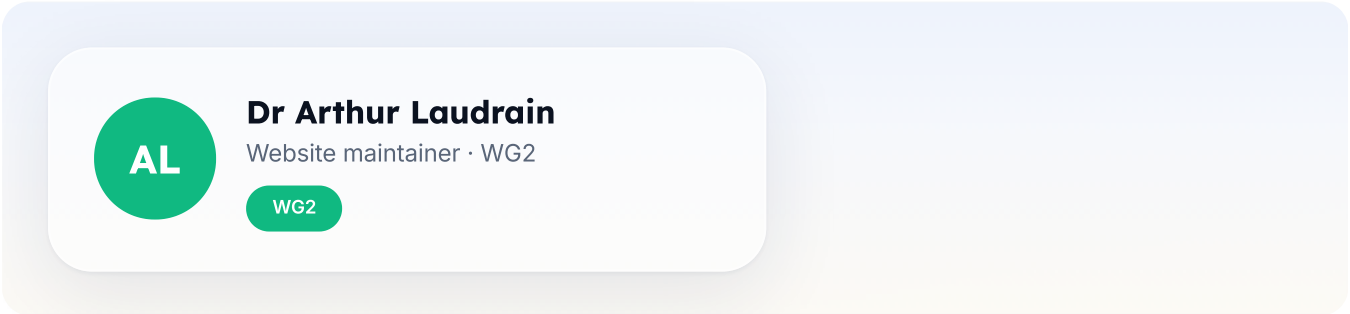
Buttons



Labels & chips

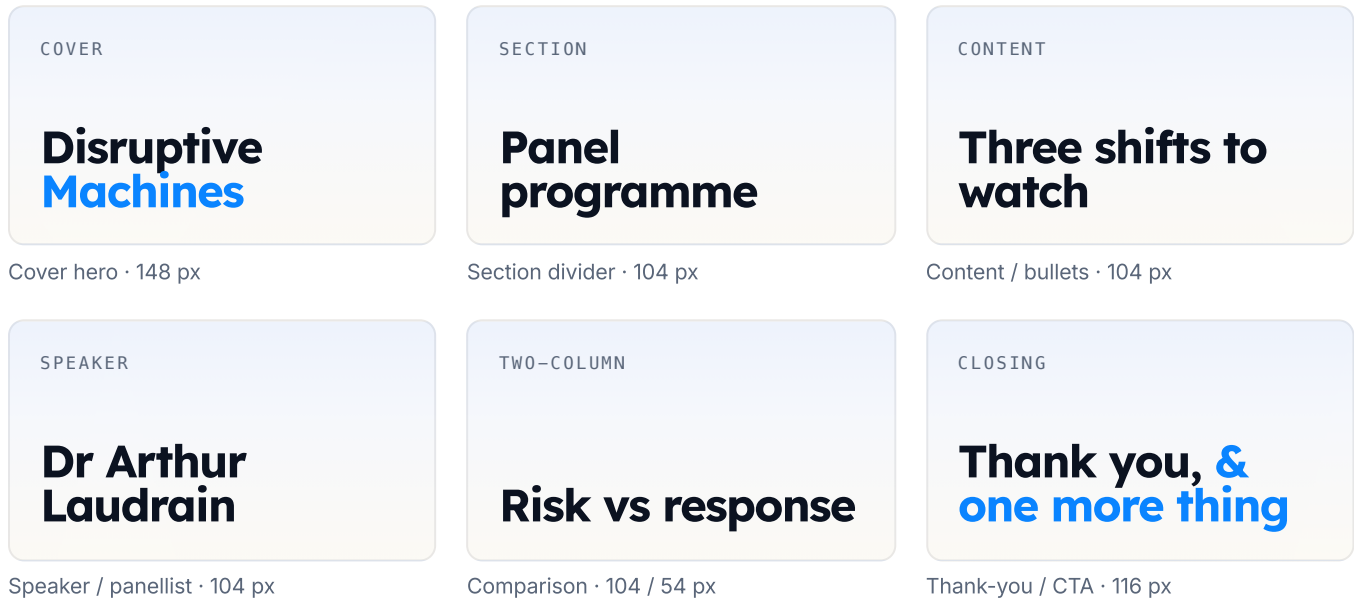


Member card (directory)



Conference deck

Eight layouts in the NetSec house style, one editable file, 16:9. Downloaded as PowerPoint or Keynote from slides.html and built for a non-technical presenter. A fixed 1280×720 canvas, so headings are set in absolute pixels rather than the responsive scale. Lexend carries every headline, the accent-blue span reserved for one emphasised phrase.



Sources. Website and brand repo: github.com/EISSeuropa/netsec.github.io (authoritative design doc docs/design-system.md, tokens and stylesheet assets/css/site.css). Live site: netsec-cost.eu. The EISS lockup belongs to EISS and must not be recoloured or redrawn.